VS-10 Customer and Stakeholder Engagement

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Purpose and Scope

VS-10.0 ensures the statistical organization remains connected, relevant, and responsive to the needs of those it serves. It builds and maintains mutual understanding and trust between the NSI and its users, data providers, partners, and policy stakeholders. Because official statistics exist to create **public value**, the organization must understand what stakeholders need, communicate transparently, and keep products, services, and policies aligned with real-world demand. It is **not a one-way process** — it is a continuous dialogue that turns stakeholder insight into better products, improved services, and stronger relationships. The value it creates is **relevance and public value**.

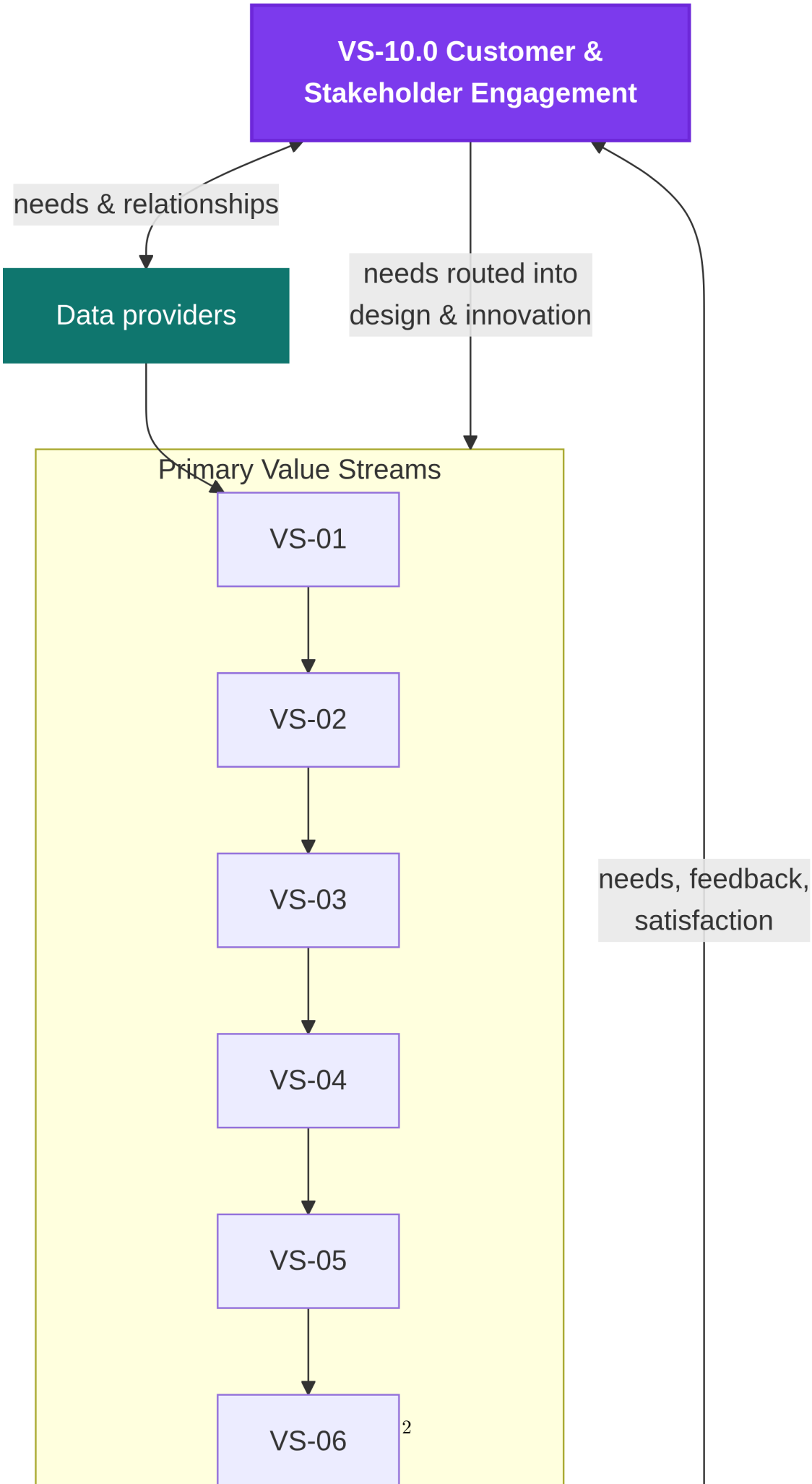
A note on numbering: each `VS-Ox.y` below is both a value stream stage (*what value* is added) and a business process (*how* it is done); the numbering maps one-to-one. See the key-concepts box above.

Position — a supporting stream that works across the whole chain

VS-10 is not a stage in the production line. It sits at the **edges** of the chain — facing both the data providers who feed VS-01 and the users who consume VS-06 — and channels what it learns inward to shape the whole chain.

! How a supporting value stream differs from a primary one

- **No steady-state data transition.** VS-10 does not move data along the chain; it moves **understanding** — needs in, communication and services out.
- **It runs continuously** as an ongoing dialogue, not per production cycle.
- **Its output is an enabling capability, not a data artefact:** understood needs, a managed service portfolio, relationships, and impact insight.
- **It aligns to GAMSO Strategy & Leadership and Corporate Support**, not to GSBPM production phases.


VS-10.0 Customer & Stakeholder Engagement
needs & relationships
Data providers
needs routed into design & innovation
Primary Value Streams
VS-01
VS-02
VS-03
VS-04
VS-05
VS-06
needs, feedback, satisfaction

How It Interacts with the Production Chain

VS-10 is the chain's two-way interface with the outside world. It is tightly coupled with **VS-01** (the data providers it engages) and **VS-06** (the users whose feedback it gathers, receiving VS-06.5's usage and satisfaction data). It translates what it hears into requirements that flow into design across the primary streams and into the **VS-08** innovation backlog.

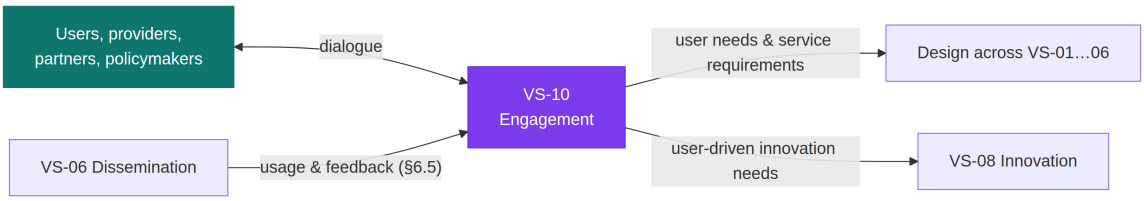


Figure 2: Interaction with the chain: needs and feedback in; communication, services, and requirements out.

Framework Alignment (GAMSO)

Where the primary streams map to **GSBPM** production phases, VS-10 maps to **GAMSO** leadership and support activities:

GAMSO area	Relevance to VS-10
Strategy and Leadership	Manage stakeholder and customer relationships; align the portfolio to strategy
Corporate Support	Manage communications, marketing, user support, and service management
SAF capabilities	Needs inventory (supports statistical design & build); customer/stakeholder management

Principles Emphasised

Principle	Statement	How VS-10 applies it
SAF-P04	Maximize the benefits for the organization	Keeps the whole chain aligned to real stakeholder value and public benefit
SAF-P08	Data is shared property	Promotes broad, equitable access and reuse of statistics and services
SAF-P02	Active support	Runs user support and service management as actively-managed services
SAF-P11	Privacy By Design	Engages data providers and users with transparency about how their data is used and protected

Roles and Actors

> **Indicative, not prescriptive**
>
> The roles below are indicative, not a mandated organizational structure. The SAF deliberately leaves organization design to each NSI — assign these responsibilities to fit your own size, culture, and operating model.

Role	Description
Head of Communication / Engagement	Owns the stakeholder strategy and the external relationship
User Researcher	Collects and analyzes user needs and satisfaction
Service / Product Portfolio Manager	Defines and manages the catalog of services and data products
Account / Relationship Manager	Manages relationships with key providers, partners, and policy users
Service Desk / User Support	Operates day-to-day user support
Communications / Outreach Officer	Runs outreach, workshops, and knowledge-sharing events
Impact Analyst	Measures use, societal impact, and satisfaction

The Value-Stream Flow

VS-10's six business processes form a continuous engagement cycle — **understand → offer → deliver → measure** — that feeds back on itself.

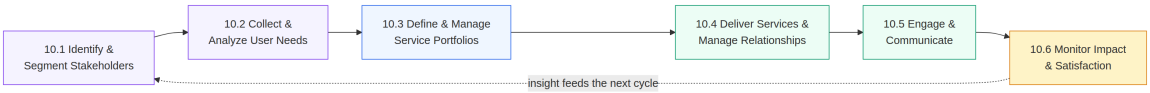


Figure 3: The six business processes as a continuous engagement cycle.

Understand — know who and what. The cycle begins by **identifying and segmenting stakeholders** (10.1): mapping the ecosystem of users, data providers, partners, and policymakers and understanding their roles and expectations. It then **collects and analyzes user needs** (10.2): gathering feedback, running consultations, and translating stakeholder needs into concrete data or service requirements.

Offer — shape the response. Those needs shape the **definition and management of service portfolios** (10.3): catalogs of business services and data products that address stakeholder needs and align with strategic goals — the bridge between what users want and what the chain produces.

Deliver — serve and communicate. Services are put into the hands of users by **delivering services and managing relationships** (10.4): operating customer support, service desks, and account management, and monitoring satisfaction and service performance. Alongside delivery, VS-10 **engages and communicates with stakeholders** (10.5): outreach, workshops, and knowledge-sharing that promote awareness and correct understanding of statistical outputs.

Measure — learn and feed back. Finally it **monitors impact and satisfaction** (10.6): measuring how data and services are used, assessing societal impact, and feeding insight back into planning and innovation — closing the loop so the next cycle of needs is better understood.

Business process	What it produces
VS-10.1 Identify and Segment Stakeholders	Stakeholder map and segments
VS-10.2 Collect and Analyze User Needs	Needs register / service requirements
VS-10.3 Define and Manage Service Portfolios	Service & product portfolio
VS-10.4 Deliver Services and Manage Relationships	Operating support & managed relationships

Business process	What it produces
VS-10.5 Engage and Communicate with Stakeholders	Outreach, communication, awareness
VS-10.6 Monitor Impact and Satisfaction	Impact & satisfaction insight (fed back to the chain)

Capability Governance

VS-10 is itself a capability that is **designed** (engagement strategy, portfolio model), **built** (support and feedback channels — with VS-09), **operated** (continuous dialogue, support, communication), and **improved** (10.6 insight). Unlike a primary stream it produces **relevance, relationships, and insight**, not statistical data, and runs as a **continuous dialogue** rather than a per-cycle production run.

Key Performance Indicators

KPI	Description	Measurement
User satisfaction	Satisfaction score across user segments and services	Per survey wave, per segment
Needs conversion	Share of captured needs converted into requirements routed to design or innovation	Per planning period
Service performance	Support response and resolution times against the service standard	Monthly
Reach and engagement	Participation in consultations and outreach; channel reach across segments	Per campaign, annually
Impact evidence	Documented uses of official statistics in policy, research, and media	Annually

Interactions, Services and Events

Counterpart	VS-10 provides	VS-10 receives	Interaction / event
Users & society	Services, support, communication, the service portfolio	Needs, feedback, satisfaction	"User need captured", "Consultation", "Service request"
Data providers (via VS-01)	Relationship management, transparency	Willingness to provide data, provider needs	"Provider engagement"
VS-06 Dissemination	Service requirements & user expectations	Usage and satisfaction data (its §6.5)	"Feedback received"
VS-08 Innovation & design across VS-01...06	User-driven needs and service requirements	New/improved products and services	"Need routed to design/innovation"

Business Objects / Artefacts

VS-10 manages enabling artefacts: the **stakeholder map and segments**, the **user-needs register**, the **service and product portfolio**, **relationship and support records**, and **impact and satisfaction metrics**. These carry user insight into the rest of the chain and are maintained continuously rather than versioned per production cycle. Each artefact nevertheless has a designated owner and a managed lifecycle (SAF-P03): changes are tracked and outdated entries are retired.

Applying This to Your NSI

Maturity Assessment Checklist

- ☐ Have we mapped and segmented our stakeholders (users, providers, partners, policymakers)?
- ☐ Do we systematically collect and analyze user needs and translate them into requirements?
- ☐ Do we manage a service/product portfolio aligned to those needs and to strategy?
- ☐ Do we operate user support and manage key relationships, monitoring satisfaction?
- ☐ Do we measure impact and feed insight back into design and innovation (VS-08)?

Scenarios

Scenario A — A new user need becomes a product. Through consultation (10.2) VS-10 learns that regional policymakers need more granular labour-market data. It logs the requirement, adds a candidate product to the portfolio (10.3), routes the need to design (VS-04/VS-05) and, where new methods are required, to VS-08. Once released by VS-06, VS-10 monitors uptake and satisfaction (10.6) and refines the offering.

Scenario B — Closing the feedback loop. VS-06.5 reports confusion about confidence intervals in a release. VS-10 analyzes the feedback (10.2/10.6), provides targeted user guidance and a plain-language explainer (10.5), and feeds a documentation improvement back to VS-05/VS-06 design — turning a usability problem into a concrete improvement.

Scenario C — A new audience emerges. Monitoring shows journalists increasingly republishing statistics from third-party aggregators, sometimes incorrectly. VS-10 identifies data journalists as a distinct segment (10.1), consults them on their needs — machine-readable releases, embeddable visuals, plain-language methodology notes (10.2) — and adds a media-service offer to the portfolio (10.3). The channel requirements are routed to VS-06 and VS-09, an embargoed media briefing service is set up under VS-07's equal-access policy (10.4/10.5), and citation accuracy in the press is tracked as an impact measure (10.6).